

Converting a Django App to a REST API

This article demonstrates how easy it is to convert a Django app into a REST API using the REST framework. The underlying assumption here is that the reader's machine has a working version of Python and Python-pip.



Django is a well-known Web framework, which allows developers to develop ORM-based apps at a fast pace. If you don't have Django installed on your system, use `pip install Django` on a terminal. It will install Django on your system.

Once Django is installed, let's create a project, within which we will create a `contacts` app. Open a terminal or command prompt and execute the following command [refer to Figure 2]:

```
[root@localhost work]# pip install django
WARNING: Running pip install with root privileges is generally not a good idea. Try 'pip install --user' instead

Collecting django
  Downloading Django-1.11.3-py2.py3-none-any.whl (6.9MB)
    100% |#####| 7.0MB 153kB/s
Collecting pytz (from django)
  Downloading pytz-2017.2-py2.py3-none-any.whl (454kB)
    100% |#####| 491kB 1.4MB/s
Installing collected packages: pytz, django
Successfully installed django-1.11.3 pytz-2017.2
[root@localhost work]#
```

Figure 1: Installing Django using Pip

```
[work@localhost demoapp]$ django-admin startproject myproject
[work@localhost demoapp]$ cd myproject/
[work@localhost myproject]$ django-admin startapp contacts
[work@localhost myproject]$
```

Figure 2: Creating a project and app

```
cd myproject
django-admin startapp contacts
```

Open the `myproject` directory and you can see the structure shown in Figure 3.

Open `models.py` in the `contacts` directory and create a class `Contact` to represent the contact:

```
from django.db import models

# Create your models here.
```

```
class Contact(models.Model):
    firstname = models.CharField(max_length=100)
    lastname = models.CharField(max_length=100, null=True, blank=True)
    address = models.TextField(max_length=100)
    city = models.CharField(max_length=100)
    state = models.CharField(max_length=100)
    country = models.CharField(max_length=100)
    home_phone = models.
IntegerField(null=True, blank=True)
work_phone = models.
IntegerField(null=True, blank=True)
home_other = models.
IntegerField(null=True, blank=True)
work_other = models.
IntegerField(null=True, blank=True)
mobile_prim = models.IntegerField()
mobile_seco = models.
```

```
IntegerField(null=True, blank=True)
```